

Garon Alexander Clements

Senior Data Engineer | Cloud Data Platforms | Azure & Databricks

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Profile

Senior Data Engineer with deep experience building and operating cloud-based data platforms, specializing in Azure, Databricks, SQL, and Spark. Proven expertise in designing, optimizing, and supporting scalable ELT/ETL pipelines that improve data quality, performance, and cost efficiency in production environments. Strong background in developing reliable, analytics-ready data solutions that enable enterprise reporting and data-driven decision-making. Known for effective collaboration with analytics, product, and engineering teams, with a focus on performance tuning, data reliability, and long-term platform stability.

Professional Experience

Senior Data Engineer, The Hanover Insurance Group

08/2024 – Present

- Own and optimize **end-to-end data pipelines**, from source ingestion through curated analytics layers, enhancing **reliability** and **timeliness** of enterprise reporting and downstream applications, improving delivery speed by **~15%** across diverse business domains.
- Design, develop, and scale **ELT workflows** on **modern cloud platforms** (Azure Databricks, Synapse), structuring **curated data layers** that ensure consistent, trusted access by analysts and business users, driving **data-driven decision-making**.
- Build and maintain **complex SQL- and Spark-based transformations**, with a focus on **performance tuning**, **code scalability**, and **data quality**, ensuring robust performance in high-volume, long-running production environments.
- Apply **partitioning strategies**, **incremental processing**, and **proactive monitoring** to improve **pipeline reliability** and **reduce reprocessing costs** by **~20%**, while ensuring **efficient resource utilization** and optimal processing performance.
- Partner with **analytics, product, and engineering teams** to define and deliver **production-ready data solutions** that transform **ambiguous business requirements** into **scalable, actionable** data insights.
- Implement **automated data validation**, **reconciliation processes**, and **alerting frameworks** that proactively detect and resolve data issues, improving accuracy and meeting **data freshness SLAs** consistently.
- Contribute to the creation and maintenance of **data engineering standards**, **documentation**, and **best practices**, ensuring platform stability, reducing onboarding time, and promoting **sustainable data engineering** practices within a regulated, enterprise-scale environment.

Senior Data Engineer, Park Place Technologies

01/2020 – 07/2024

- Owned **end-to-end data pipelines** from source ingestion through curated analytics layers, supporting **enterprise reporting, analytics, and operational use cases** across multiple business domains.
- Designed and built **scalable ELT workflows** on **Azure-based cloud data platforms**, processing **tens of millions of records per day** into well-structured, analytics-ready datasets consumed by **100+ internal users**.
- Developed, optimized, and maintained **complex SQL- and Spark-based transformations** in **Azure Databricks**, with a strong focus on **performance tuning**, **code maintainability**, and **long-term reliability** in production environments.

- Improved **pipeline performance and stability** by applying **partitioning strategies, incremental processing patterns, and query optimization**, reducing job runtimes by **~30%** across high-volume workloads.
- Drove **cloud cost efficiency improvements** by optimizing **compute usage, job scheduling, and data layouts**, reducing overall processing costs by **~20%** without impacting data freshness SLAs.
- Partnered closely with **data architects, analytics teams, and business stakeholders** to evolve **data models and platform architecture** in response to growing data volume, complexity, and reporting needs.
- Owned **production pipeline reliability**, including monitoring, alerting, failure recovery, and root cause analysis, ensuring **consistent data freshness and SLA adherence** for downstream analytics and reporting.
- Implemented **data quality validation, reconciliation logic, and automated checks** to proactively detect issues, reduce defects, and improve trust in analytics outputs.
- Supported and enhanced **long-running production data systems**, balancing new feature development with **technical debt reduction and platform sustainability**.
- Contributed to **data engineering standards, documentation, and best practices**, improving onboarding efficiency, code consistency, and long-term maintainability of the data platform.
- Served as a **senior technical contributor and mentor**, providing guidance on **data modeling, scalable pipeline design, and Spark performance optimization** across multiple initiatives.

Data Engineer / Data Analytics Consultant, C Space

12/2012 – 12/2019

- Designed, built, and supported **analytics-focused data pipelines and SQL Server-backed data systems**, enabling consistent, reliable reporting and analysis across internal teams and multiple client-facing research and consulting initiatives.
- Developed and maintained **complex SQL transformations, views, and stored procedures** to curate analytics-ready datasets, supporting ad hoc analysis, recurring reporting, and executive-level insights used in client deliverables and internal decision-making.
- Acted as a **data analytics consultant**, partnering directly with research, analytics, and client delivery teams to translate ambiguous research questions and business requirements into clearly defined datasets, data models, and repeatable reporting solutions.
- Collaborated closely with cross-functional teams to ensure **data definitions, transformations, and outputs** aligned with analytical intent, stakeholder expectations, and evolving project requirements.
- Improved **data reliability and trust** by implementing validation checks, reconciliation logic, and documentation practices, reducing **data-related issues and reporting discrepancies** by **~25%** across commonly used datasets.
- Supported and optimized **SQL Server-backed production analytics systems**, improving **query performance and report responsiveness** by **~20%** through indexing strategies, query tuning, and incremental schema refinements.
- Standardized **SQL patterns, data definitions, and documentation**, improving consistency, maintainability, and onboarding efficiency for analysts and consultants working with shared datasets.
- Enabled **self-service analytics** by designing reusable datasets and reporting structures that reduced dependency on ad hoc data requests and manual data preparation, allowing teams to focus on higher-value analysis.

Data Analyst, Investor Group Services (IGS)

05/2008 – 12/2012

- Supported **data quality, validation, and accuracy initiatives** across multiple operational datasets, ensuring consistency and integrity in all reporting outputs, which were critical for informed business decisions and client-facing reports.
- Conducted thorough **data analysis** on large datasets to identify trends, anomalies, and actionable insights, which directly contributed to more efficient internal processes and optimized reporting mechanisms for senior management and client teams.

- Developed and maintained a suite of **SQL queries** to automate **data extraction, transformation, and loading (ETL)** processes, significantly improving the **timeliness** and **accuracy** of reports and reducing manual effort by streamlining workflows across multiple teams.
- Played an instrumental role in the **design and implementation of automated reporting systems** that eliminated bottlenecks in monthly and weekly report generation, improving both the **speed and accuracy** of key performance metrics tracking for internal stakeholders.
- Contributed to the **development of interactive dashboards** for senior leadership, enabling them to access real-time business metrics and make quicker, more informed decisions that impacted multiple departments and client deliverables.
- Collaborated with various business units to provide **ad hoc data analysis** and tailored reports, supporting key initiatives and helping stakeholders identify areas for **improvement** or **optimization** based on data-driven insights.
- Gained significant experience in **data modeling** and **data integration** while ensuring that the infrastructure maintained robust data quality controls, which laid the groundwork for future roles in more complex data engineering and platform work.
- Worked closely with cross-functional teams to translate **business requirements into technical specifications**, ensuring the design and delivery of **customized data solutions** that met both short-term project goals and long-term data management strategies.

Skills

Data Engineering (ELT/ETL Pipeline Architecture | Data Integration and Transformation | Data Warehousing | Data Lakes | Batch and Streaming Data Processing | Scalable Data Pipeline Design)

Cloud Platforms (Azure Databricks | Azure Synapse Analytics | Azure Data Factory | Azure Data Lake | AWS Redshift | Google BigQuery | Cloud-Native Data Architectures)

Programming & Query Optimization (SQL (Advanced Querying, Stored Procedures) | Python (Data Processing, Automation) | SparkSQL | Distributed Computing | Performance Tuning | Query Optimization)

Big Data & Processing Technologies (Apache Spark | Hadoop | Kafka | High-Volume Data Processing | Fault-Tolerant Data Systems)

Data Analytics & Visualization (Data Modeling (Dimensional and Analytics-Ready Models) | Descriptive and Predictive Analytics | Power BI | Tableau | Analytics Reporting | Self-Service Analytics Enablement)

Data Governance & Quality (Data Validation and Reconciliation | Data Quality Frameworks | SLA Management | Data Freshness Monitoring | Data Lineage | Data Security and Access Controls)

Collaboration & Technical Leadership (Cross-Functional Collaboration | Technical Mentorship | Agile and Scrum Methodologies | Stakeholder Communication | Technical Strategy and Best Practices)

Education

Bachelor of Science, Interactive Media and Game Development, Worcester Polytechnic Institute

09/2004 – 06/2008 | Worcester, MA